Heuer with Allan on the 1998 tour to Australia. So, ja, he buys golf shoes and I buy TAGs. Different product, but the same concept!

I didn't always get on with everyone, though …

Daryll Cullinan

Daryll was the one teammate I could never figure out. Obviously, he was one helluva gifted cricketer; as a batsman, the guy was a genius. I have always thought that, out of all the players I've played with and against, Daryll always looked like he had more time to play the ball than anyone else. He looked like he was playing the ball in slow-mo, that's how good he was. He had the ability to make the quickest bowler in the world look like a medium-pacer. That said, he wasn't that great against a certain Aussie leggie, though, was he?

Daryll and I didn't get off to the best start (as discussed in Chapter 6), and for the rest of our time as teammates, the two of us never got on. At all. I always felt that I had to force a conversation with Daryll, as he wouldn't just come and talk to you, you know. You never felt that you could actually have a decent conversation with the man, and I believe most guys in our team shared my feelings.

At first, though, Daryll was mates with Pat Symcox and Brian McMillan, but when they retired, he got quite isolated … which was a little sad, as I'd always admired him as a player.

Daryll even managed to get up my nose when he finished playing cricket and started to do some TV commentary. When I got three centuries in a row against the West Indies during the 2004 Test series in South Africa – two 142s and a 192 – he didn't congratulate me and say 'well done'. No, he asks me: 'So, when are the 300s coming?' He was being dead serious too. It wasn't just some off-the-cuff remark. He was obviously implying that I was incapable of getting a triple century … unlike him. But that's Daryll; he always liked to say his little piece. He was never shy of a word.

Daryll met his nemesis in the spin-bowling of Shane Warne, though. There was Daryll, one of the few guys I'd pay good money to go and watch, and Warnie put the brakes on his career a little. I never quite understood why Daryll couldn't play Warnie. Perhaps if he was a more likeable chap I would have asked him. But someone – I think it was Robin Jackman – had an interesting theory about this. According to him, it was the trajectory and bounce of the flipper with which Shane often got Daryll out – the ball that